

KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN ERNAKULAM REGION

PRE-BOARD I -ENGLISH COMMUNICATIVE (CODE NO: 101)

CLASS X (2024-25)

TIME: 3HRS

MAX MARKS-80

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions very carefully and strictly follow them:

I. This question paper has 12 questions. All questions are compulsory.

II. This question paper contains four sections:

Section A: Reading skills

Section B: Writing skills

Section C: Grammar

Section D: Literature Textbook.

III. Attempt all questions based on specific instructions for each part. Write the correct question number and part thereof in your answer sheet.

IV. Separate instructions are given with each question/part, wherever necessary.

V. Adhere to the prescribed word limit while answering the questions.

SECTION A - READING SKILLS (22 marks)

1. Read the following passage

12 Marks

1. The phrase “A thing of beauty is a joy forever” from John Keats’ poem ‘Endymion’, encapsulates the enduring power of beauty to inspire, uplift and provide lasting happiness. This line, which has resonated with readers since its publication in 1818, serves as a reminder of the profound impact that beauty - whether in nature, art or human experiences - can have on our lives.

2. ‘Endymion’ is a narrative poem that reflects Keats’ fascination with mythology, nature and the interplay between beauty and human experience. The poem tells the story of Endymion, a shepherd who falls in love with the moon goddess Selene. Throughout the poem, Keats explores themes of love, beauty, and the pursuit of truth. The famous line about beauty serves as the poet’s thematic anchor, suggesting that true beauty is not merely a momentary pleasure but a source of everlasting joy.

3. Keats’ assertion that “a thing of beauty is a joy forever” invites readers to consider the various forms that beauty can take. Beauty can be found in the natural world, such as in the

blooming of the flowers, the colours of a sunset, or the serene sound of a flowing river. It can also manifest in artistic creations, from the brushstrokes of a painting to the verses of poetry. In human experiences, beauty is present in acts of kindness, love and connection. The beauty we encounter often elicits feelings of happiness and contentment, creating a lasting imprint on our hearts and minds. This lasting joy is not fleeting; rather it is a wellspring of inspiration that can sustain us through life's challenges.

4. Keats' line emphasizes a deep connection between beauty and joy. When we encounter something beautiful, we experience a rush of emotions-wonder, awe and peace. These feelings can enhance our mental and emotional well-being, providing solace in difficult times. The joy derived from beauty acts as a refuge, reminding us of the positive aspects of life. Moreover, beauty has a unique ability to transcend time and space. A beautiful painting, a haunting melody, or a breathtaking landscape can transport us, allowing us to experience emotions and memories that may have otherwise faded. This transcendence is what makes beauty a "joy forever", it connects us to our past and helps us envision a brighter future.

5. In our fast-paced, modern world, it can be easy to overlook the beauty that surrounds us. Daily stresses, technological distractions, and the hustle and bustle of life can dull our senses. However, cultivating an awareness of beauty in our lives, whether it is through taking a walk in park, listening to a favorite song, or simply enjoying a quiet moment of reflection, can foster a sense of joy that lasts.

6. John Keats' assertion that "a thing of beauty is a joy forever" serves as a powerful reminder of the transformative power of beauty in our lives. It invites us to seek out and appreciate the beauty that exists in the world, in our relationships, and within ourselves. By doing so, we not only enrich our own lives but also contribute to a more compassionate and joyful world. In the words of Keats, let us cherish beauty, for it is indeed a source of everlasting joy.

Answer the following, based on the passage above.

I. Beauty might be overlooked in modern life because of 1

- A. a lack of natural beauty around us
- B. daily stresses and technological distractions
- C. excessive artistic output
- D. abundance of leisure time.

II. What does Keats' assertion invite readers to do? 1

- A. ignore the beauty around them
- B. dismiss artistic expressions
- C. seek and appreciate beauty
- D. compare beauty to wealth

III. Complete the following suitably.

Acts of kindness and compassion can be seen as forms of _____, contributing to our collective joy. 1

IV. Rectify the given false statement

The joy from beauty is often fleeting and offers little comfort during difficult times. 1

V. TRUE OR FALSE 1

Beauty can only be appreciated in nature, according to Keats.

VI. How does Keats define the relationship between beauty and joy in his poem 'Endymion'? 1

VII. In what ways can beauty manifest in nature, according to the text? 2

VIII. What are some emotional responses that beauty elicits, as mentioned in the passage? 2

IX. How can appreciating beauty within us contribute to a more compassionate world? 2

2. Read the following passage 10 marks

FROM POLLUTION TO PROSPERITY: THE ECONOMIC IMPLICATIONS OF A PLASTIC BAN

1. The growing concern over plastic pollution has led many countries to implement bans on single- use plastics. This initiative aims to protect the environment by reducing the amount of plastic waste that ends up in landfills and oceans, where it poses significant threats to wildlife and marine ecosystems. Environmental advocates argue that plastics take hundreds of years to decompose, leaching harmful chemicals into the soil and waterways during that time. By reducing plastic consumption, we can foster a healthier planet, ensuring cleaner habitats for future generations.

2. However, the economic implications of plastic ban cannot be overlooked. The plastic industry provides millions of jobs worldwide, from manufacturing to retail. A sudden shift away from plastic can lead to job losses and affect livelihoods, particularly in regions where the economy heavily relies on plastic production and recycling. Moreover, the transition to alternate materials, such as biodegradable plastics or reusable containers, often comes with higher production costs, which can result in increased prices for consumers. Business may struggle to adapt, especially small enterprises that lack the resources to invest in sustainable alternatives.

3. Balancing environmental protection with economic stability is crucial as we navigate the complexities of a plastic ban. Policymakers must develop strategies that support a gradual transition, offering incentives for businesses to adopt sustainable practices and investing in research for innovative alternatives. Public awareness campaigns can also educate consumers about the importance of reducing plastic use and encourage them to support businesses that prioritize sustainability. By fostering collaboration between governments, industries and communities, we can work towards a solution that benefits both the environment and the economy.

Answer the following, based on the passage above.

I. Fill in the blanks with appropriate word/phrase. 1

To balance environmental protection with economic stability, policymakers must develop strategies that support a _____ transition and offer incentives for businesses to adopt sustainable practices.

II. Which of the following options is **NOT** mentioned as a consequence of plastic pollution in the passage? 1

- i. Harmful chemicals leaching into soil and waterways
 - ii. Increase in air pollution
 - iii. Threats to marine ecosystems
 - iv. Long decomposition time for plastic waste
- A. i & iv
 - B. i & iii
 - C. Only ii
 - D. iii & iv

III. What challenge does the plastic ban pose for businesses, according to the passage? 1

- A. Reduced consumer demand for products
- B. Job losses in the retail sector
- C. Higher production costs for alternative materials
- D. Lack of government support for the ban

IV. Why do environmental advocates argue that plastic waste is particularly harmful to ecosystems? 1

V. TRUE OR FALSE 1

The transition to biodegradable plastics is easier and less costly for small businesses than larger enterprises.

VI. Explain the potential economic impact of a sudden plastic ban on regions that rely on plastic production and recycling. 1

VII. Complete the sentence.

Public awareness campaigns are important in reducing plastic use because 2

VIII. Analyze the main environmental issues associated with plastic pollution, as highlighted in the passage. How does reducing plastic consumption contribute to a healthier planet? 2

SECTION B -WRITING SKILLS (22marks)

3. You are Satvika/ Satvik, class leader of Class X B. The projector in your classroom is malfunctioning. Report this to the Principal in an email using not more than 50 words. You may copy the given template to write your email. 3

From:	
To:	
Cc:	
Date:	
Subject:	

4. Write a factual description, in not more than 100 words of the most interesting person you have ever met. 4

5.A. As a member of the Ecotourism Society of India, draft a letter to the Ministry of Tourism outlining strategies to promote eco-tourism and raise awareness about responsible travel practices that conserve the environment. Use ideas from MCB units 'Environment' and 'Travel and Tourism'. (maximum 120 words) 7

OR

5.B. You have come across an article about the harm to the environment due to e- waste, meaning the electronic waste generated by people throwing away their obsolete, unwanted and non-functional electronic and electrical equipment and appliances like mobiles, laptops, TV sets, radios, old refrigerators etc. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily making people aware of the problems that rise due to e- waste. Use ideas from MCB units on 'Science' and 'Environment'. You are Samvrutha / Samanyu of H.NO: 123, Street Road, Chennai, TN.

(maximum 120 words)

6.A. Write an article on the significance of physical health in our daily lives, highlighting its impact on mental well-being, the consequences of neglecting physical activity, and the importance of discipline in maintaining overall health, on World Health Day, using the clues given and taking ideas from the MCB unit 'Health and Medicine'.

(maximum 150 words)

8

Clues:

- Interconnection between physical and mental health
- Benefits of regular physical activity (weight management, improved mood, increased energy)
- Importance of discipline in maintaining a healthy lifestyle
- Modern life's challenges (time constraints, busy schedules) and solutions (simple exercises, healthy habits)
- Role of physical health in achieving overall well-being.

OR

6.B. Write an article for a school publication on the topic "The Importance of Inclusive Education in Building a Fair and Equitable Society." In your article, discuss how inclusive education ensures equal opportunities for all students, regardless of their abilities or backgrounds. Highlight the role of schools and teachers in fostering an environment of respect and diversity, and how inclusive education prepares students for life in a diverse world. You may use ideas from the MCB unit 'Education'. (maximum 150 words)

SECTION C- GRAMMAR (10 marks)

7. Fill the blanks (I)- (III) with the appropriate option from those in the brackets. 3

I. To excel in your studies, you _____ (can/shall/must) practice regularly and stay organized. Consistency in effort leads to better understanding and improved skills.

II. Every student in the class _____ (are/is/have) eager to participate in the upcoming science fair. The projects reflect the hard work and creativity of each participant.

III. Yesterday, the team _____ (achieved/achieving) a breakthrough in their research.

8. In the following paragraph, one word has been omitted in each line. In your answersheets, remember to write the missing word along with the word that comes before and after it, as shown below. The first one has been done as an example. 4

No:	Text	Word Before	Omission	Word after
E.g.:	Yesterday, I went the park with my friends.	went	to	the
1.	We played football in afternoon. The	-----	-----	-----
2.	weather perfect, so we stayed there for hours.	-----	-----	-----
3.	I forgot to water, so I felt very thirsty.	-----	-----	-----
4	Luckily, my friend had extra bottle.	-----	-----	-----

9. Do as directed 3

a) Rearrange the jumbled words/phrases in the given dialogue to create a meaningful sentence. 1

Person X: I heard that you're planning to start your own business soon.

Person Y: Yes, I'm working on the business plan and looking for investors.

Person X: how/planning/handle/are/challenges/unforeseen/you/the/ to/that
might/arise/during/process/the/?

b) Report the dialogues to complete the paragraph that follows. 2

John: I will visit Paris next week.

Anna: Oh, that's exciting! Have you been there before?

John: No, it's my first time. I have always wanted to see the Eiffel Tower.

John said that he would visit Paris the following week. Anna replied that it was exciting and asked (I)----- . John responded that it was his first time and mentioned that (II)-----.

SECTION D - LITERATURE TEXT BOOK (26 marks)

10. Read the excerpts given and answer the questions briefly, for **ANY TWO** excerpts of the three given. 2x4=8

A. "Evidently the wrong animal had been hit, and the beast of prey had succumbed to heart-failure, caused by the sudden report of the rifle, accelerated by senile decay."

I. What did Mrs. Packletide aim for and what did she hit instead?

II. Explain the expression 'senile decay'.

III. What ultimately caused the tiger's death?

IV. How does this incident reflect Mrs. Packletide's hunting skills?

B. "CAESAR: And this way have you well expounded it.

DECIUS BRUTUS: I have, when you have heard what I can say:

And know it now: the senate have concluded

To give this day a crown to mighty Caesar.

If you shall send them word you will not come,

Their minds may change."

I. The word 'it' in the first line of the extract refers to ----- .

II. What decision has the senate made regarding Caesar?

III. What consequence may occur if the speaker does not attend?

IV. What does the crown symbolise?

C. "Were these people pulling his leg? Was the whole thing a gigantic hoax? A meek harmless man like him, and they had to drag him into the middle of the city to make a laughing stock of him."

I. Who is the person mentioned here?

II. Why does he think that he is being made a 'laughing stock'?

III. What does the word 'hoax' mean?

IV. Who are 'these people'?

11. Answer **ANY FIVE** of the following six questions in 30-40 words each. (5x2=10)

I. How do Nicola and Jacopo's actions reflect the themes of sacrifice and responsibility in 'Two Gentlemen of Verona'?

II. Lack of confidence and her gullible nature led the nightingale in 'The Frog and the Nightingale' to her unfortunate end. Elucidate.

III. The poet has a dual attitude towards the snake in the poem 'Snake'. Why does he experience conflicting emotions on seeing the snake?

IV. Human nature is very unpredictable. Justify this statement with reference to the context of the poem 'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner'.

V. Why do you think the rich and powerful people get monuments and statues erected in their memory? (Not Marble, Nor the Gilded Monuments)

VI. What did the ghost in 'A Shady Plot' say about her life before she became a ghost?

12. Answer **ANY ONE** of the following two questions in about 150 words. 8

I. The poem 'Ozymandias' highlights the vanity of human glory and power. Elaborate.

OR

II. Even at the time when the grandfather is supposedly dead, the sisters are trying to pull each other down. With reference to the play 'The Dear Departed', mention the qualities / traits that the sisters display. Do you approve of them? Give a reasonable answer.